

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

3th July, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

27th WEEK



MOSUL & IS

UPSC CSE – GS III

GS III ... LINKAGES OF ORGANIZED CRIME WITH TERRORISM.

2

Victory in Mosul

The city has been taken from the IS. The Iraqi government now needs to win over its people

The capture by Iraqi forces of the Grand al-Nuri Mosque in Mosul, from where Islamic State leader Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi declared himself 'caliph' in July 2014, marks the end of the 'caliphate' in Iraq. For three years, the mosque was a symbol of power for the IS, whose black flag flew atop the historic 150-ft tall al-Hadba minaret. IS fighters blew up the minaret when they retreated, practically declaring their defeat in Iraq's second largest city. They are now confined to some pockets of Mosul, and Iraqi commanders believe it is only a matter of days before they can declare total victory. For the Iraqi troops, the eight-month battle has been particularly torturous, given the high casualties and the strong IS resistance, on the battlefield and through suicide attacks elsewhere. It is quite a turnaround for the Iraqi army, which left its barracks and fled the city without even a nominal fight three years ago when it came under IS attack. The ease with which the IS took Mosul, home to over a million people, had raised alarming questions about the professional capability of the Iraqi army to defend its territory against further possible IS expansion. But Prime Minister Haider al-Abadi, who ordered the Mosul mission and stayed the course despite the huge challenges involved, has put to rest such concerns, for now.

Mr. Abadi managed to stitch together a difficult alliance to fight the jihadists. While the elite Iraqi counter-terror forces led the ground battle, Iran-trained Shia Popular Mobilization Units as well as the Kurdish Peshmerga militia also joined in. The U.S. provided air cover. Despite conflicting interests – the U.S. and Iran are rivals while both Tehran and Baghdad have uneasy ties with the Kurds – the joint front they forged against the IS could be a replicable model elsewhere, especially in Syria where the IS still controls territories. For Mr. Abadi, however, a bigger challenge is to rebuild Mosul, where hundreds of thousands of people have been displaced, and prevent the regrouping of the IS. The destruction of the 'Caliphate', the proto-state that Baghdadi established, doesn't mean that the IS as an insurgency has been defeated. The group is likely to retreat to Iraq's deserts, much like what al-Qaeda in Iraq, the predecessor of the IS, did during 2006-10 after the death of its leader, Abu Musab al-Zarqawi, and subsequent military blows. They struck back when they found an opportunity in crisis-stricken Syria and in Iraq's restive Sunni belt, including Mosul, which was simmering against the sectarian policies of Nouri al-Maliki's Shia regime. The IS may also bide its time. Mr. Abadi should reassure Mosul's population that his government will not make the mistakes his predecessor committed. He has retaken the city, and now he has to win over its people.

THE  HINDU

Date : 3rd July, 2017



TURKEY

SYRIA

IRAQ

IRAN

JORDAN

SAUDI ARABIA

KUWAIT

Mediterranean Sea

Cyprus

Lebanon

Israel

Gulf of Aqaba



TURKEY

SYRIA

IRAQ

JORDAN

Israel

Lebanon

Cyprus

PALMYRA

DAMASCUS

Mediterranean Sea

KUWAIT

Gulf of Aqaba



TURKEY

Cyprus

Mediterranean Sea

Lebanon

Damascus

SYRIA

Israel

JORDAN

Mosul

Baghdad

IRAN

IRAQ

KUWAIT





**ABU_BAKR_AL-
BAGHDADI**



Abu_bakr_al-Baghdadi declared himself "caliph" in July 2014 and now it came to an end as Iraqi forces captured this mosque in Mosul



HAIDER AL-ABADI
Prime Minister, Iraq



IRAQ

Haider Al Abadi, Prime Minister, Iraq ordered the Mosul Mission and in spite of huge challenges, he stayed the course.

**SADDAM HUSSEIN**

- USA and its Allied Forces invaded Iraq in 2003 to depose Saddam Hussein with two reasons.
 1. He possessed weapons of mass destruction and
 2. Had ties with Al-Qaeda
- And he was captured and executed finally on 30th December 2006.
- Subsequently instability occurred in several areas of Iraq due to corruption and Sunni-Shia rivalry.

2

Victory in Mosul

The city has been taken from the IS. The Iraqi government now needs to win over its people

The capture by Iraqi forces of the Grand al-Nuri Mosque in Mosul, from where Islamic State leader Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi declared himself 'caliph' in July 2014, marks the end of the 'caliphate' in Iraq. For three years, the mosque was a symbol of power for the IS, whose black flag flew atop the historic 150-ft tall al-Hadba minaret. IS fighters blew up the minaret when they retreated, practically declaring their defeat in Iraq's second largest city. They are now confined to some pockets of Mosul, and Iraqi commanders believe it is only a matter of days before they can declare total victory. For the Iraqi troops, the eight-month battle has been particularly torturous, given the high casualties and the strong IS resistance, on the battlefield and through suicide attacks elsewhere. It is quite a turnaround for the Iraqi army, which left its barracks and fled the city without even a nominal fight three years ago when it came under IS attack. The ease with which the IS took Mosul, home to over a million people, had raised alarming questions about the professional capability of the Iraqi army to defend its territory against further possible IS expansion. But Prime Minister Haider al-Abadi, who ordered the Mosul mission and stayed the course despite the huge challenges involved, has put to rest such concerns, for now.

WHAT IS THE NEED OF THE HOUR?

- 1 The present operation is possible because of support of air cover by USA and Iran's Shia Popular Mobilization Units as well as Kurdish Peshmerga militia.
- 2 There is every possibility that IS may spread its base to desert areas of Iraq.
- 3 They should be decimated and should not be allowed just like what happened in Al-Qaeda case, where fringe elements in the name of Al-Qaeda are operating in several countries.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

D. Sunil Kumar

V. Dayakar James

Y. Sri Poojita

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9